

UK: Royal Standards

Like other monarchies, the UK has a wide range of flags which are armorial or semi-armorial, for the leading members of its royal family. In the case of HM Queen it is necessary to distinguish between her role as Queen of the United Kingdom and her other Realms, and as Head of the Commonwealth. In addition to her British Royal Standard she has standards for other Realms.



**ROYAL STANDARD
OF THE UNITED
KINGDOM**

This form has been in use since the accession of Queen Victoria in 1837 and depicts the three areas united to form the United Kingdom (England, Scotland, and Northern Ireland). Strictly, flags of this kind are armorial banners rather than “standards.”



**PRINCE PHILIP
DUKE OF
EDINBURGH**

The banner for Prince Philip has quarters representing his descent from the royal families of both Denmark and Greece, and from the Mountbattens, and his title Duke of Edinburgh is represented by the arms of the city.



**HRH PRINCE CHARLES
FOR USE IN WALES**

For personal visits to Wales and as his own flag, the Prince uses the banner of the Principality of Wales with his crown on a green shield over all in the center. The Prince also has banners for his titles in Cornwall, Rothesay, and as Lord of the Isles.



**QUEEN AS HEAD
OF THE COMMONWEALTH**

This is used when the Queen is not in a “Queen’s Realm” (i.e., a country of which she is directly the Head of State) or in one which does not have a local Royal Standard. It is a banner with Her Majesty’s initial “E”, a gold crown, and chaplet of roses.



**HRH PRINCE
CHARLES PRINCE
OF WALES**

The banner is an adaptation of the Royal Standard, with a “label” for an eldest son; a white bar with three points, and the quartered arms of the Principality of Wales over all in the center. Labels are used for children and grandchildren of the Queen.

OTHER ROYAL STANDARDS

Other members of the Queen’s family who have standards based on the Royal Standard are the Princess Royal, the Duke of York, Earl of Wessex, and the Queen’s royal cousins. There is a general banner for those members of the royal family not entitled to an individual standard.